

David Robert
905 375 4174
david.connor.r[at]gmail.com

Portfolio:
www.davidrobert.computer

Creative Technologist & Interactive Systems Designer

I apply emerging technologies to experiences in the physical world.

Experienced in art studios & design agencies & research labs.

I believe technology can and *will* create a more alive, participatory, and engaging physical world.

Passionate about architecture & performance & film & fashion (& technology)

Experience

- Creative Technologist (R&D)
Antimodular Research Inc.,
Atelier Lozano-Hemmer
Montreal QC
November 2023 - September 2024
January 2025 - Present

 - Designed, implemented, and deployed real-time interactive systems for public artworks by Rafael Lozano-Hemmer, developing durable interfaces used by thousands of participants, primarily using Python and TouchDesigner.
 - Led research and development of multimodal AI pipelines, including computer vision, data analysis, generative text and image systems, and audience-tracking interfaces, with an emphasis on robustness, latency, and legibility in public space.
 - Translated conceptual proposals into working prototypes, iterating rapidly between artistic intent and technical constraints to shape interactions and system behavior with Rafael and production teams.
- Media Artist in Residence
Fabrica Research Centre
Treviso TV, Italy
September 2024 - December 2024

 - Conceived, realized, and exhibited an interactive installation, exploring AI mimicry and vocal embodiment. Built using TouchDesigner and Python.
 - Developed the work through critique and cross-disciplinary exchange within an international residency cohort, centered around the theme of Ruralism.
- Creative Technologist / Lab Assistant
Design + Technology LAB,
Toronto Metropolitan University
Toronto ON
September 2021 - April 2022
September 2022 - April 2023
September 2023 - November 2023

 - Assisted in day-to-day operations of the lab, including maintenance and operation of lab equipment. This includes 3D printing, laser cutting, XR, and robotics.
 - Created an interactive installation for DesignTO 2022 using TouchDesigner, OpenVR, a KUKA robot arm, and full-stack web development.
- Research Assistant [AI]
Technology Research in Performance Lab,
Toronto Metropolitan University
Toronto ON
September 2022 - April 2023

 - Researched human–AI co-performance, building experimental systems that merged live theatre with generative AI.
 - Built a real-time theatrical AI-improvisation system using cloud-based AI tools, serving as an early prototype of interactive dialogue with AI in public performance.

Education

BA in Media Production
Concentration in Digital Media
4.27 / 4.33 GPA
Toronto Metropolitan University
Toronto ON
September 2019 – April 2023

Publications

David Bouchard, Cintia Cristia, David Robert, Michael Bergmann. 2022. **Augmented Symphony: An augmented reality application for immersive music listening.** In *Proceedings of EVA London 2022*. Computer Arts Society, London, England, UK.

Exhibitions

David Robert. **I SURRENDERED MY BODY AND I SUCCUMBED TO THE BEAST.** At *Until the Very End*. Treviso, Italy. *Contribution: Artist*

David Robert, Alex Verni, Design + Technology LAB. 2022. **Assembly Line.** At *DesignTO 2022*. Toronto, Canada. *Contribution: Lead Developer and Designer.*

David Robert, Alex Verni, Stacy Cernova, Anthony Baloukas. 2022. **Moth Melody.** At *Ontario Science Centre*. Toronto, Canada. *Contribution: Lead Developer.*

Teaching Assistant [Physical Computing] Toronto Metropolitan University Toronto ON September 2022 - December 2022	- Assessed students and gave feedback on projects for RTA 321: Intro to Tangible Media. - Supported students with Arduino programming and simple circuit design.	Skills -Python -TouchDesigner -ROS 2 -Isaac Sim & Isaac Lab -Arduino -Raspberry Pi -ComfyUI -JavaScript & Node.js -Unreal Engine -Unity
Creative Developer Intern Jam3 Toronto ON May 2022 - August 2022	- Built a browser-based 3D demo (Three.js, React, Node, MongoDB) showing how small businesses could interact with the Metaverse. Delivered as a client-facing prototype. - Worked in a fast-paced, autonomous intern team of developers, designers, and a coordinator.	
Research Assistant [AR] Toronto Metropolitan University Toronto ON July 2021 - April 2022	- Developed an AR app using Unity [C#] centred on enhancing digital delivery of orchestral music through spatial and interactive audio. - Co-authored peer-reviewed paper accepted to EVA London 2022.	-3D printing -Circuit design -Laser cutting -Workshop tools
Additional Experience		
Undergraduate Researcher [Sim Developer & HRI Designer] Synaesthetic Media Lab, Toronto Metropolitan University Toronto ON September 2022 - December 2022	- Collaborated with a joint university research team to prototype interactive, networked “boat-drones” for live performance environments. - Designed and programmed a simulation environment in Unreal Engine 5 (C++) and built real-time communication systems (Python server, WebSockets, I2C) to synchronize physical and virtual performance elements.	
Interactive Developer Ontario Science Centre Toronto ON January 2022 - April 2022	Designed and delivered a projection-based audio installation that engaged families and children, turning abstract tech into playful, intuitive interaction. Ensured reliability for constant public use.	
Code Coach Toronto Metropolitan University Toronto ON September 2021 - April 2022	Helped students fix issues in their creative coding projects and tutored them on core programming concepts.	
Undergraduate Researcher [Unreal AR Developer] Synaesthetic Media Lab, Toronto Metropolitan University Toronto ON January 2021 - April 2021	- Designed and developed an AR HoloLens 2 application in Unreal Engine 4 [Blueprints]. - The app supports training for medical workers through the manipulation of medical models with gestures and tools.	
Fabrication Technician Philip Beesley Studio, Living Architecture Systems Group Toronto ON February 2020 - March 2020	Fabricated components for an interactive installation that was part of the 2021 Venice Biennale of Architecture.	